

Zerolock Manifesto

Technology should serve those who use it. Not those who sell it.

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0. The System

This did not happen by accident.

Over the last thirty years, a precise model was built: convince you that technology is too complex to understand, too expensive to own, too risky to manage yourself. Better to rely on someone big. Better to pay every month. Better not to ask questions.

This was not a mistake. It was a design.

Large platforms do not sell software. They sell dependency. Every automatically renewed subscription, every file uploaded to servers you cannot see, every system that stops working the moment you stop paying: these are not market failures. They are the market.

The result is a world where billions of people and millions of organizations own nothing they use every day. They pay to access. They pay to continue. They pay to avoid losing what they thought was theirs.

We refuse this model.

Not because it is technically wrong. But because it is humanly wrong.

1. Your Data

Calling it "the cloud" is a polite lie.

Your files, your emails, your documents, your team's conversations: they are on physical servers, in real buildings, in countries you did not choose, under laws you did not vote for.

The US Cloud Act of 2018 allows American authorities to access any data held by American companies, anywhere in the world. Without notifying you. Without asking your permission. Without you being able to do anything about it.

This is not a theory. It is the law.

Every time you upload a document to a foreign platform, you are accepting this. Not because you consciously decided to. Because nobody ever told you clearly.

We are telling you now.

Your data must reside where you decide. On infrastructure you control. Under rules you have chosen. Without intermediaries who can change the terms tomorrow morning.

Your data must be yours. This is not a demand. It is a right.

2. Your Software

Have you ever actually read the terms of service of what you use every day?

Nobody does. They are written not to be read. Dozens of pages of legal language that say, in essence, one thing: we can change everything, at any time, and you cannot do anything about it.

The price goes up. You accept it. The feature you relied on disappears. You accept it. Your account gets suspended. You accept it. Your files become unreadable without their program. You accept it.

You accepted all of this the moment you clicked Agree.

What you call your software is not yours. It is licensed. It is rented. It is conditional. It exists as long as someone in an office on the other side of the world decides it should exist, at that price, with those features, under those rules.

Software you cannot study, modify, or take away is not a tool. It is a dependency.

We use only software that belongs to those who use it. Code that anyone can read, verify, and improve. Tools that exist independently of any company, any subscription, any commercial decision made without you.

It is called open source. It has existed for decades. It is mature, professional, reliable.

And it does not ask your permission to keep working.

3. Your Security

Security has become a product.

You buy it by subscription, renew it every year, measure it in features listed on a spec sheet. Antivirus, managed firewall, cloud backup, 24-hour monitoring. All packaged, all invoiced, all dependent on someone you have never met.

The problem is that buying security does not mean having it.

A system you do not understand, you cannot defend. A system you do not control, you cannot trust. A system built on proprietary, closed, opaque foundations has vulnerabilities you cannot see and that someone else knows better than you.

Real security is not bought. It is built.

It is built by choosing systems you can understand. Code you can read. Architectures you can verify. Tools that a global community analyses, tests, and improves every day, publicly, without hidden agendas.

Linux runs the servers of central banks, military institutions, and critical infrastructures around the world. Not because someone sold it well. But because decades of public analysis have made it the most tested and reliable system that exists.

That same solidity is available to anyone.

It is not a privilege of large organisations. It does not require enormous budgets. It requires only the choice to build instead of buy.

4. Your Infrastructure

Try asking your current IT provider this question: if I decide to leave tomorrow, what do I take with me?

The answer, in most cases, is: little or nothing.

Your data is in proprietary formats. Your configurations exist only in their systems. Your emails are on servers you do not control. Your backups are accessible only through their software. Your team knows how to use only their tools.

This is not a coincidence. It is engineering.

It is called lock-in. The practice of building systems that work perfectly as long as you stay, and become a problem the moment you want to leave. It is not illegal. It is not even hidden. It is simply how most of the IT market works.

Infrastructure you cannot take away is not yours. It is held hostage.

We build systems that belong to those who use them. Everything documented. Everything based on open standards. Everything transferable. If you decide to change provider tomorrow, you take everything with you: data, configurations, tools, history.

Not because we are generous. But because we believe that a client who is free to leave and chooses to stay is worth infinitely more than a client who has no alternative.

The freedom to leave is proof that you are truly inside by choice.

5. Your Value

How long have you been thinking of IT as a cost?

A line in the budget. A recurring expense to minimise. Something that must work without causing trouble and cost as little as possible. A necessary evil.

This is how most organisations think about technology. And it is exactly how the market wants you to think about it.

Because those who think of IT as a cost do not ask questions. They renew the subscription, pay the invoice, wait for something to break. They do not evaluate alternatives. They do not build anything. They own nothing.

An open source, documented, independent IT infrastructure is not an expense. It is an investment that accumulates over time. The systems you install today will still be yours in ten years, without you having paid a cent in licensing fees in the meantime. The skills your team develops stay in the organisation. The architecture you build becomes part of your assets.

If you ever sell the organisation, that infrastructure has value. If you look for an investor, that independence has value. If the market changes, that flexibility has value.

IT should not be what holds you still. It should be what allows you to move.

Stop paying to depend. Start building to own.

6. The Choice

An alternative exists. It is not future. It is not experimental. It is not for experts.

It is available now, it works now, it is used now by governments, universities, hospitals, banks, and millions of organisations around the world. It has decades of development behind it, a global community improving it every day, and zero dependency on companies that can change the rules tomorrow morning.

It is called open source. And the reason you do not know it is not that it is inferior.

It is that it is inconvenient for those who live on subscriptions.

Choosing open source does not mean giving something up. It means stopping accepting conditions you did not negotiate. It means using tools you can understand, modify, take away. It means having technology that answers to you, not to a contract signed years ago with someone you no longer remember.

This is not an ideological choice. It is a practical one.

It is the choice of those who have understood that technology should serve those who use it. Not the other way around.

The question is not whether you can afford to choose differently. The question is whether you can afford to continue as you are.

7. We

We are not a company that decided to use Linux.

We are people who stopped accepting a broken model and chose to build something different. Technicians, professionals, entrepreneurs, who have seen from the inside how the system works and decided it was not worth defending.

We believe technology is a tool for freedom. Not dependency.

We believe the data of a person or organisation belongs to that person or organisation. Without exceptions, without conditions, without clauses written in small print.

We believe software you cannot understand should not be forced upon you. And that software you do not own should not be called yours.

We believe security must be built on open, verifiable, independent foundations. Not bought by subscription from those who have an interest in selling you fear before the solution.

We believe IT infrastructure must be an asset. Not a contract.

We refuse lock-in as a business model. We refuse dependency as a condition of service. We refuse opacity as an industry standard.

We are not against technology. We are against the use of technology to take power away from those who should have it.

We build systems that last. That belong to those who use them. That work independently of any company, subscription, or commercial decision made without you.

This is what we believe. This is what we do.

If you believe it too, you are already part of this.